



10 Theme: social organization

Themes · IB Diploma · Concept guide and original exam-style practice

Understand the concept

Social organization covers sub-topics such as education, employment, social relationships, law and community structures. Productive tasks on this theme, such as formal letters or opinion essays, often require a persuasive or informative stance on how a community or institution should act, so strong responses combine a clear position with realistic, specific proposals rather than vague general statements.

Worked example: follow the reasoning

Model opening for a formal letter proposing a change: 'I am writing to propose that our local council introduce a mentorship programme pairing unemployed young people with local business owners, in order to address the rising youth unemployment rate in our district.'

Quick check · multiple choice

Which sub-topic falls under the theme of social organization?

- A Personal travel memories
- B Education systems and employment
- C Renewable energy sources
- D Traditional festivals

Write your choice: _____

Structured practice

Answer in the space provided.

- 1 Write a formal letter of 250-400 words to your school's administration proposing a change to how part-time work opportunities are advertised to students, explaining the current problem and your proposed solution. [25]

Final answer: _____



Answers and explanation

Question 1 [25]

A strong response includes:

- Formal salutation and matching sign-off
- Clear statement of the current problem, such as students missing opportunities because information is scattered or hard to find
- A specific, realistic proposal, such as a centralized noticeboard or weekly email list
- Supporting reasoning or a brief example showing why the change would help
- A polite closing request for consideration or a meeting
- Consistently formal register with no contractions or slang
- Word count within 250-400 words

Quick check answer

B. Education and employment structures are core sub-topics of social organization, alongside law and community relationships.

Self-assessment

Compare each credited step with your own answer. Fix the first reasoning or content error, then retry the practice question without looking at the solution.

Based on the IB English B guide (2018).

Original FagusED teaching material. Not an official IB publication; the sample scenarios and language are invented and generic.